

VERJ SOLAR

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT OFFICER TRAINING WORKBOOK

Sales • Technical Knowledge • The "You" Factor

Redefine Your Limit

SALES • TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE • FINANCING • THE "YOU" FACTOR

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INTRODUCTION

About VERJ SOLAR

VERJ SOLAR is a premier renewable energy provider committed to delivering reliable, efficient, and modern power solutions to residential, commercial, and industrial clients. Our goal is to replace energy instability with clean, uninterrupted power across Nigeria.

Purpose of the BDO Training

This workbook is designed to equip you with the fundamental skills, technical understanding, financing options, and personal character required to succeed as a VERJ Business Development Officer (BDO). By mastering the content within these pages, you will build the confidence needed to identify opportunities, educate potential customers, and generate sustainable income.

The VERJ BDO Role & Flexible Structure

- **Flexible Involvement:** You do not need to work full-time or quit your day job to be a successful BDO. You can seamlessly sell solar while keeping your regular 9-to-5 job, running your personal business, or studying.
- **Self-Generated Opportunity:** As a BDO, you generate your own leads and build your own network. You leverage your existing connections, workplace, community, and social channels to identify potential clients.
- **Support System:** You are backed by VERJ SOLAR's technical engineering team, dedicated WhatsApp operational groups, official financing partners, and structured support.

How to Use This Workbook

Work through each module systematically. Pay close attention to the learning outcomes, technical boundaries, financing workflows, and customer engagement formulas. Use the concepts outlined here as your daily operational field manual.

MODULE 1 — SALES & MARKETING

Finding opportunities, understanding customers, and converting relationships into business.

Learning Outcome: At the end of this module, the BDO should be able to identify and generate quality leads, engage prospects professionally, understand their energy needs, present appropriate solutions, handle basic objections, and follow up effectively using the sales funnel concept.

Unit 1: The Role of a VERJ BDO

As a BDO, you are the face of VERJ SOLAR in your community and professional network. Your primary goal is not just to "sell hardware," but to solve energy problems for homes and businesses.

- You identify people and organizations struggling with high grid bills, expensive diesel/petrol generator costs, or power outages.
- You initiate meaningful conversations and collect their basic power requirements.
- You register these opportunities into the VERJ BDMS system to lock in your lead ownership.

Unit 2: Lead Generation & The Sales Funnel

Lead generation is the fuel of your business. To build a consistent income pipeline, you must understand The Sales Funnel:

TOP OF FUNNEL	→	Leads Generated (Conversations started)
MIDDLE OF FUNNEL	→	Engaged Prospects (Load assessment & Quote sent)
BOTTOM OF FUNNEL	→	Closed Sales (Installation & Commission earned)

Understanding the Funnel Dynamics

- It is a Numbers Game: Not every person you speak to at the Top of the Funnel will buy immediately. That is completely normal.
- Don't Get Discouraged: A prospect who says "No" or "Not now" today is not a lost lead. They fall into two high-value categories:
 1. Future Buyers: Their budget or circumstances may change tomorrow, next month, or next year.
 2. Referral Sources: Even if they don't buy themselves, a satisfied and well-informed prospect will gladly refer their boss, colleague, relative, or neighbor to you.

Unit 3: Starting the Customer Conversation

Initiating a solar conversation should feel natural, whether you are at your 9-to-5 workplace, a social gathering, or online.

- Focus on Pain Points: Ask about their current power situation rather than pitching products.
- "How many hours of light do you get daily in your area?"
- "How much are you spending monthly on petrol/diesel for your generator?"
- "How are the constant power interruptions affecting your business operations?"

Unit 4: Customer Needs Discovery

Before suggesting any system size, you must listen and collect accurate information:

- What appliances do they need to run? (e.g., Lights, TVs, Refrigerators, Air Conditioners, Pumping Machines).
- When do they need power most? (Daytime operations vs. Nighttime backup).
- What is their desired backup duration during outages?

Unit 5: Presenting the Solution

Presenting a solution means connecting the customer's pain point to VERJ SOLAR's value:

- Focus on long-term savings (calculating money saved on fuel over 1–3 years).
- Emphasize convenience and peace of mind (automatic changeover, silent operation, zero smoke/fuel hassle).
- Highlight VERJ SOLAR's quality, warranty, and professional installation standards.

Unit 6: Handling Customer Objections & Staying Top-of-Mind

When a customer raises concerns (e.g., "Solar is too expensive" or "I'm not ready yet"):

- Acknowledge & Validate: Never argue. Say, "I completely understand why cost is a major consideration."
- Introduce Installment Financing: Position solar not as an unmanageable upfront cost, but as a flexible monthly investment through VERJ Solar Financing.
- Stay Top-of-Mind:
 - If a prospect hesitates, keep the relationship warm. Send occasional helpful tips, VERJ installation photos, or energy-saving advice via WhatsApp or social media without being pushy.
 - When their generator breaks down or fuel prices rise again, you will be the first person they call because you remained top-of-mind!

Unit 7: Follow-Up & Lead Management

None

- Record Everything: Use the VERJ BDMS platform to log every interaction, quote sent, and follow-up date.
- Prompt Updates: Always do what you promised—if you agreed to send a quote by 2:00 PM, ensure it is delivered on time.
- Nurture Past Leads: Regularly check in on prospects in your funnel who haven't bought yet. Persistence and consistency turn cold prospects into closed deals.

MODULE 2 — BASIC TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE

Understand the technology well enough to explain it confidently—and know when to involve the technical team.

Learning Outcome: At the end of this module, the BDO should be able to explain the basic components and principles of a solar energy system, identify customer loads, and collect the information required for proper system design without making unsupported technical claims.

Unit 1: Understanding Solar Energy

Solar energy systems capture sunlight using photovoltaic (PV) panels, convert it into usable electricity, store excess energy in batteries, and power household or commercial appliances smoothly.

Unit 2: The Major Components

A complete VERJ solar system consists of four primary building blocks:

1. Solar Panels (PV Modules): Capture sunlight and generate Direct Current (DC) electricity.
2. Inverter: The "brain" of the system. Converts DC electricity from panels/batteries into Alternating Current (AC) electricity used by regular appliances.
3. Batteries: The "bank" or storage unit. Holds energy so the customer has power at night or during grid failure (Lithium-ion or Tubular/Gel).
4. Charge Controller: Manages the voltage and current coming from the solar panels to safely charge the batteries without overcharging (often built into modern hybrid inverters).

Unit 3: Understanding Electrical Loads

Electrical loads are divided into two primary categories:

- Inductive Loads (High Initial Surge): Appliances with motors or compressors that require a heavy spike of power to start up (e.g., Air Conditioners, Pumping Machines, Freezers, Washing Machines).
- Resistive Loads (Constant Power): Appliances that draw a steady, predictable amount of power (e.g., LED Bulbs, Televisions, Computers, Laptops, Fans).

Unit 4: Power & Energy

- Power (Watts / Kilowatts - W / kW): The rate at which energy is consumed at any given instant.
- Example: A 100W bulb draws 100W of instant power. (1,000W = 1kW).
- Energy (Watt-hours / Kilowatt-hours - Wh / kWh): Power consumed over a period of time.
- Example: Running a 100W bulb for 10 hours = 1,000Wh or 1kWh.

Unit 5: Understanding Battery Capacity

Battery capacity is measured in Ampere-hours (Ah) or Kilowatt-hours (kWh).

- Batteries store the energy that keeps appliances running when neither grid nor solar power is available.
- Overseeing depth of discharge and proper sizing ensures battery longevity.

Unit 6: Solar Generation

Solar panels require direct sunlight to generate full power. Peak sunshine hours in Nigeria generally range between 4 to 6 hours daily. System design must account for rainy seasons and cloudy days.

Unit 7: The BDO's Technical Boundaries

CRITICAL RULE: As a BDO, you are an opportunity finder and relationship builder—not an engineer.

- **DO:** Collect accurate appliance lists, take photos of customer distribution boards/generators, and log details into BDMS.
- **DO NOT:** Guarantee system sizing on the spot, invent technical specs, or promise that a small system can run heavy industrial loads.
- **ALWAYS:** Rely on the VERJ technical/engineering team to perform final load calculations, site assessments, and official system design.

MODULE 3 — SOLAR FINANCING & PAYMENT BY INSTALLMENT

Enabling customers to spread the cost of their solar systems conveniently over time.

Learning Outcome: At the end of this module, the BDO should be able to guide a prospect seamlessly through the VERJ Solar Financing application process, communicate key requirements, manage expectations around payment plans, and coordinate execution timelines.

Unit 1: Overview of VERJ Solar Financing

One of the most powerful tools in your sales toolkit is Payment by Installment. High upfront costs can sometimes cause prospective buyers to hesitate. VERJ Solar Financing bridges this gap by allowing vetted customers to acquire solar power immediately while spreading payments over a flexible tenure.

Unit 2: Who Qualifies for VERJ Solar Financing?

VERJ Solar Financing is designed to be highly inclusive to help you convert a wide range of opportunities in your network.

QUALIFIED CATEGORIES:

- Private Individuals (Salaried workers, self-employed professionals, homeowners).
- Small & Medium Businesses (SMEs) (Shops, supermarkets, clinics, offices, bakeries).
- Large Corporations / Big Businesses (Factories, commercial complexes, corporate headquarters).
- Worship Centers (Churches, mosques, religious institutions).
- Registered & Unregistered Businesses (Both formal corporate entities and informal/sole proprietorship operations).

Unit 3: Applicant Eligibility & Core Requirements

Before initiating a financing application, inform the prospect of the compulsory documentation required by our financing partners:

MANDATORY FINANCING REQUIREMENTS:

- 12-Month Bank Statement (Active bank account showing clear cash flow/income).
- National Identification Number (NIN).
- Bank Verification Number (BVN).

Unit 4: Stage 1 — Load Schedule & Solution Recommendation

- Step A: You collect the customer's detailed load schedule (appliances, quantity, usage pattern).
- Step B: You forward this load schedule to the VERJ technical team via your dedicated WhatsApp group.
- Step C: The technical team calculates the load and recommends the ideal solar solution package.
- Step D: You present the recommended solution to the customer and secure their acceptance.

Unit 5: Stage 2 — Solution Acceptance & Payment Simulation

- Step A: Once the customer accepts the technical recommendation, notify the team via your dedicated WhatsApp group.
- Step B: The VERJ team simulates a customized 3 to 12-month payment plan, tailored to the customer's preferred repayment tenure.
- Step C: You present the monthly payment schedule to the customer. The customer reviews and agrees to proceed.

Unit 6: Stage 3 — Application Submission & Verification

- Step A: Collect the customer's core details:
 - Full Name
 - Phone Number
 - Email Address
- Step B: Send these details to your dedicated WhatsApp group.
- Step C: The prospect receives an automated SMS and Email containing a secure application link.
- Step D: The customer clicks the link, fills out their full credentials, and uploads their documents (12-month bank statement, NIN, BVN).
- Step E: Upon submission, the financing partner reviews the application, conducts a credit score check, and determines eligibility.

Unit 7: Stage 4 — Approval, Equity Contribution & Installation Timeline

- Approval Notification: If qualified, the applicant is contacted directly via Text, Email, or Phone Call with approval confirmation and instructions for their initial equity contribution payment.
- Installation Execution Timeline:
 - Within Lagos: Installation occurs within 4 to 5 business days following initial equity payment confirmation.
 - Outside Lagos: Installation occurs within 7 to 10 business days following initial equity payment confirmation.
- Note: This timeframe accounts for the disbursement of funds by the financing partner and regional logistics.

MODULE 4 — THE "YOU" FACTOR

How your personal character, self-image, and carriage directly drive trust and close deals.

Learning Outcome: At the end of this module, the BDO should understand that long-term sales success is driven by "The You Factor"—how you carry yourself, how you view your self-worth, how you communicate integrity, and how your personal aura converts skeptical prospects into loyal clients.

Unit 1: You Are the VERJ Brand

People do not buy solar hardware first; they buy you first. Every time you interact with a prospect—in person, on the phone, or via text—your personal identity and VERJ's corporate identity blend together.

- The customer's perception of VERJ SOLAR is formed by how reliable, punctual, and prepared you appear.
- Your character is the strongest marketing collateral you will ever present.

Unit 2: The Power of Self-Image & Closure

Your closing rate is directly tied to your internal self-image. If you see yourself as a "desperate salesperson asking for a favor," prospects will sense hesitation and pull back.

- **Shift Your Mindset:** View yourself as a high-value Energy Consultant bringing a transformative solution to a customer who desperately needs reliable power.
- **Confidence Closes:** When you respect your own time and expertise, customers respect your advice and take your recommendations seriously.

Unit 3: Carriage, Confidence & Aura

Carriage is the silent language of success. Long before you open your mouth to discuss solar capacity or payment plans, your visual aura has already made a statement.

- **Professional Presentation:** Ensure clean, sharp attire (whether corporate, smart casual, or branded VERJ apparel).
- **Body Language:** Maintain strong posture, steady eye contact, a warm smile, and a firm handshake.
- **Poise Under Pressure:** Even when a customer raises tough questions, stay relaxed and grounded. True authority never panics.

Unit 4: Communication That Wins Trust

Closing deals requires clear, high-trust communication.

- **Listen More Than You Speak:** Allow the customer to express their frustrations with power grid issues and fuel costs completely before offering solutions.
- **Speak with Clarity:** Eliminate hesitation words ("um," "maybe," "I think"). Use clear, respectful, and direct language.
- **Keep Every Promise:** If you say, "I will send the payment schedule by 3:00 PM," ensure it hits their inbox at 2:55 PM. Reliability creates irresistible trust.

Unit 5: Your Digital Brand & Perception

Because you operate as a BDO alongside your job or business, your online presence (WhatsApp Status, LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook) is an active reflection of "The You Factor."

- Share professional, value-driven content: energy-saving tips, VERJ installation photos, and client success stories.
- Maintain a clean profile picture and professional bio so prospects searching for you online see a credible, trustworthy representative.

Unit 6: Uncompromising Integrity & Company Rules

CHARACTER & FINANCIAL RULES:

- Zero Personal Payments: All funds (outright purchases or financing equity payments) must go directly into official VERJ SOLAR or partner accounts. BDOs never collect cash or personal account transfers.
- Absolute Honesty: Never misrepresent system specs or make false promises just to force a deal closed.
- Zero Unauthorized Discounts: Respect official pricing models without trying to bypass rules.

Unit 7: The Professional Growth Mindset

A high-performing BDO never stops growing. Treat every rejection as feedback, continuously refine your carriage, sharpen your communication skills, and constantly elevate your self-image to command higher-value deals.

THE VERJ BDO STANDARD

To succeed as a VERJ BDO, you must embody the eight core pillars of our professional standard:

- **Honest:** Truthful in every presentation, calculation, and promise.
- **Professional:** High standards in appearance, speech, and conduct.
- **Respectful:** Valuing the customer's time, space, and budget.
- **Confident:** Grounded in knowledge, high self-image, and backed by a solid team.
- **Knowledgeable:** Understanding products, basic tech concepts, financing options, and sales processes.
- **Reliable:** Following through on commitments without fail.
- **Accountable:** Owning your actions and staying disciplined.
- **Customer-focused:** Prioritizing the client's real energy needs above all else.

THE VERJ BDO FORMULA

Follow this step-by-step formula for every opportunity you encounter:

FIND	→	Find opportunities in your network, workplace, and community.
ASK	→	Ask the right questions about their current power challenges.
LISTEN	→	Listen carefully to understand their true energy needs.
RECORD	→	Capture accurate load details and register the lead in BDMS.
SOLVE	→	Connect the customer to the right VERJ solution (Outright or Financing).
FOLLOW UP	→	Stay engaged, stay top-of-mind, and nurture your sales funnel.
DELIVER	→	Keep your word and uphold every promise made.
BUILD TRUST	→	Earn long-term relationships, repeat business, and organic referrals.

REDEFINE YOUR LIMIT

VERJ SOLAR